

company for satellite TV, WiFi and phone connections – eg. Airtel. This will give you great leeway in negotiations as you’ve already scored brownie points by being a top-notch, exclusive customer ^[15].

2) Rent:

If your idea of a rich life is living in a fabulous home, then go ahead by all means. If that rich life also means contributing enough for the future, then cutting down on rent is an 80-20 solution. Once you take the step to move into a smaller apartment or bring in another room-mate, your savings is on automatic for the remainder of the year.

What you were paying previously	What you’ve downsized to	Amount saved on automatic (per year)	What if you invested just 12,000 toward your retirement?	Is it worth the trade off?
6000	5000	12,000	4.3L after 37 years off 10.2% returns	<i>Yes for me! Your decision?</i>

3) Transportation:

It is common knowledge that public transport will always be economical as compared to private transport. Hence using the bus or metro even once every week, will bring in small savings – enough to fund your weekend dinner. But, one of the jeers of life is traffic and I highly recommend getting a private transport if it lessens the transit time.

Cutting down guilt-free spend

There is an eerie case of judgement, when it comes to cutting down guilt free spend. When we try to save more and cut down spending, quite often, the Jekyll and Hyde approach seems enticing: we move from no savings in the past to cutting down 40% expenses within a month. Motivation of this kind works as a fine graduation speech. But in the day-to-day expanse, we lose steam within hours and get back to the bad habits of the past.